

Ernest SONG

Chief Growth & Transformation Officer

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Profile

Finance leader with 15+ years leading accounting, financial-close and ERP replacement mandates for multi-entity, multi-country organisations (BE, FR, NL). My expertise lands on the JD's core needs: Erp, Financiers, Processus. I specialise in General Accounting (GL, AP, AR), Business Blueprint sign-off, workshops with stakeholders, and guiding ERP transformations from AS-IS diagnosis to go-live. General Accounting (GL, AP, AR) and financial-close leadership, and in guiding ERP replacements from AS-IS diagnosis to SAP S/4HANA go-live. What sets me apart is perspective: I've sat on both the operator's and the executive-recruiter's side of the table, so I read the numbers and the organisation behind them. I bring calm under pressure, rigorous Power BI / Cognos reporting, and a genuine commitment to turning finance into a lever for growth.

Experience

Engie SEM, Strategic Business Analyst & Finance Automation Lead (Freelancer)

Brussels, BE

- Led the financial controlling pilot phase for the SAP S/4HANA migration across French subsidiaries, successfully acting as the core Business Analyst bridging IT architecture and strategic business operations.
- Designed, built, and deployed a robust, automated budget modeling tool from scratch within a critical 2-week timeline, ensuring operational continuity during a resource gap and replacing an unreliable legacy framework.
- Streamlined and automated financial closing processes for commodity trading activities, deploying advanced PowerQuery ETL workflows to safely ingest batches of 1,500+ bookings per close with zero human intervention.
- Reconciled complex financial data structures between middle-office databases (IVDB) and SAP S/4HANA while restructuring and simplifying the Work Breakdown Structure (WWS) project codes to optimize portfolio monitoring.

Jan 2026 – present
9 months

Degroof Petercam, Performance Management Project Leader

Brussels, BE

- Finance Transformation Operating Model (FTOM)
- Designed and implemented a client-centric performance management system.
- Optimized finance close process for improved governance, internal control, and data quality.
- Led projects related to regulatory reporting sourcing and followed BPM standards.
- Conducted gap analysis of business requirements and existing procedures to identify areas for improvement.

Jan 2018 – Dec 2018
1 year

Magnetrap, Freelance CFO / Fundraising Consultant

Mons, BE

- Acted as interim CFO and led fundraising, organizing €3M in debt/equity fund raises.
- Created cash flow projections, business plans, and long-term financial goals.
- Monitored company performance and implemented corrective actions as needed.
- Prepared operating results reports and managed financial models for long-term use.

Nov 2020 – Jan 2022
1 year 3 months

Engie Tractebel, Cash Flow & Financial Modeling Specialist (Freelancer)

Brussels, BE

- Design cashflow reporting and cash exposure per project.
- Assessment of financing needs in local entity, credit analysis of specific counterpart and impairment testing.
- Develop Finance data modelling from SAP for HANA and design Power BI reporting.

Mar 2023 – Dec 2023
10 months

Shurgard , Investment & Corporate Development Analyst (Freelancer) - Analyzed and managed real estate projects, including construction, redevelopment, and acquisition of self-storage businesses. - Maintained project dashboard and initiated corporate development projects to improve department policies and procedures. - Designed the data model and visualization for the Investment department's Business Intelligence efforts. - Collaborated in the development of a new pricing model using Artificial Intelligence.	Brussels, BE Feb 2022 – Feb 2023 1 year 1 month
Rexel , Freelance Finance Consolidation & Reporting Consultant - Led the implementation of IFRS financial reporting for Asia-Pacific, Latin America, and Canadian subsidiaries. - Spearheaded the restructuring process and integration of SAP BPC and Cognos reporting systems. - Performed annual budgeting, monthly forecasting, and analyses of actual vs. budgeted/estimated results. - Led the strategic planning process for the organization.	Paris, FR Sept 2014 – Jan 2016 1 year 5 months
KPMG Audit , Financial Auditor Supervisor - Conducted audits of financial statements using various accounting standards, including testing of key processes in accordance with SOX requirements. - Experienced in auditing financial modeling for long-term contracts, particularly in the context of Public-Private Partnerships (PPP). - Certified FP7 Grant Agreements for the EU Research program and led audit teams and supervised financial auditors. - Developed partnerships and identified new markets to support business growth. - Main sector: Construction (Vinci, Eiffage, Colas), Real estate (Nexity), Water distribution (Veolia), International parcels distribution (Geopost from La Poste group), Security (Brink's), Healthcare (DomusVie).	Paris, FR Jan 2011 – Aug 2014 3 years 8 months
ICM - Brain & Spine Institute , Deputy CFO Trainee - Implemented the budget system and prepared business plans for the scientific teams. - Established the internal control system for purchasing and donation processes and managed bank reconciliation. - Prepared the institutional audit necessary for the certification by the 'Comité de la Charte'.	Paris, FR Nov 2009 – Aug 2010 10 months
Holcim , Senior Operational Excellence & Data Lead (Freelancer) - Leveraged data insights derived from market analysis to restructure production workflows post-M&A, significantly enhancing efficiency. - Managed SAP HANA migration, restructuring data and ensuring system integrity. - Developed rebate models (matrix & automated SAP), aligning with commercial strategy. - Implemented QlikSense with new data for financial reporting and insights. - Ensured data reliability and liaised with auditors on rebate matters.	Nivelles, BE Jan 2024 – Dec 2025 2 years
Tobania , Director Business Process Automation - Led development and implementation of citizen developer business model using RPA and self-service BI, including pricing strategy and roadmap. - Managed business development, including marketing strategy, pre-sales, and sales, and identified new business opportunities. - Implemented process optimization, standardization, and harmonization to improve efficiency and profitability for customers. - Provided regular, tailored reports to help customers monitor and control costs and make data-driven business decisions, and established change management structures and strategies to facilitate successful adoption of new processes and technologies.	Brussels, BE Feb 2020 – Oct 2020 9 months

Vinci Airports , Managing Director & Head of Project Financial Modeling / Cursus Grand Talent - Value creation: valuation at 4 times of acquisition cost. - Led deployment of airport operations at 50+ locations in various countries. - Developed long-term financial business model including analysis of macroeconomic impact, capital expenditures, and concession valuation. - Negotiated extension of concession contract with Portuguese authorities and implemented new financial business model to improve budgeting and forecasting processes. - Managed accounting and financial reporting in accordance with BE-GAAP standards.	Brussels, BE & Lisbon, PT Feb 2016 – Dec 2017 1 year 11 months
Soap collect , Founder - Established a non-profit organization focused on providing hygiene products to disadvantaged communities. - Formed partnerships with luxury hotel chains to source used soap for reconditioning.	Phnom Penh, KH Jan 2019 – present 7 years 9 months

Education

Specialized Master's degree ESCPs Business School , #1 FT 2026 Auditing and Consulting Ranked #1 full-time Master in 2026 (FT Rankings)	Paris, FR 2011
Master's degree Université Paris Nanterre , Management Science and Financial Control Management Science and Financial Control	Paris, FR 2010

Competencies

Business

- MS Office (advanced Excel, Power Query)

ERP

- SAP HANA

Business Intelligence

- MS Power BI
- QlikSense
- Business Object
- Cognos
- Hyperion

RPA

- UiPath
- MS PowerAutomate

Agile

- Jira
- Confluence

Data & Analytics

- VBA
- SQL
- R

Financiers

Processus

Gestion

Languages

Native:

- French
- Khmer
- Teochew

Proficient:

- English

Basics:

- Dutch (A2)
- Spanish
- Mandarin

Interests

Sustainable development

Powerlifting

Mountain biking

Tennis

Interpersonal

Fast-learner

Problem solver

Diplomacy

Driven

Autonomous

Teampayer